

PLACER COUNTY SUPERIOR COURT
THURSDAY, CIVIL LAW AND MOTION
DEPARTMENT 3
THE HONORABLE MICHAEL W. JONES
TENTATIVE RULINGS FOR JUNE 25, 2026, AT 8:30 A.M.

Plaintiff's Motion for Order Permitting Filing of Amendment to Complaint for Fictitious Name Pursuant to Code of Civil Procedure Sections 474, 473(a)(1), and 576

Plaintiff's motion is granted. (Code Civ. Proc., §§ 473, subd. (a)(1), 474, 576.)
Plaintiff shall file and serve the Doe amendments on or before **July 6, 2026**.

15. S-CV-0055128 VW CREDIT v. BENEDYUK, VLADIMIR

The motion to set aside default judgment is dropped from calendar as no moving papers were filed with the court.

16. S-CV-0055608 WOOD, SCOTT v. GENERAL MOTORS

Plaintiff's Motion for Attorney's Fees and Costs

Plaintiff's motion is granted.

Civil Code section 1794, subdivision (a) allows a buyer of a vehicle to bring an action for recovery of their damages and other legal and equitable relief for any failure to comply with obligations arising under the chapter. (Civ. Code § 1794, subd. (a).) If the buyer successfully prevails in their action, he or she may recover "attorney's fees based on actual time expended, determined by the court to have been reasonably incurred by the buyer in connection with the commencement and prosecution of such action." (*Id.* at subd. (d).)

Here, plaintiff is the prevailing party because he achieved his litigation objectives. Defendant does not challenge this. Accordingly, the court must

make an initial determination of the actual time expended; and then to ascertain whether under all the circumstances of the case the amount of actual time expended and the monetary charge being made for the time expended are reasonable. These circumstances may include, but are not limited to, factors such as the complexity of the case and procedural demands, the skill exhibited and the results achieved. If the time expended or the monetary charge being made for the time expended are not reasonable under all the circumstances, then the court must take this into account and award attorney fees in a lesser amount. A prevailing buyer has the burden of "showing that the fees incurred were 'allowable,' were 'reasonably necessary to the conduct of the litigation,' and were 'reasonable in amount.' " " " "

(*Morris v. Hyundai Motor America* (2019) 41 Cal.App.5th 24, 34.)